

and R&D. I have brought this holistic view.

While the tailwinds for India are very strong, some companies are still on the fence. They want to know about the ease of doing business. And then some investors have also asked about our S&P rating (BBB-), which is much lower than that of, say, Malaysia (A-). This is a problem I have to address. While S&P ratings are not meant for investment by companies, investors also use them as a parameter for investment. **My team and I are working on what we call a landing platform where the whole country will be mapped for the six focus sectors that we have identified for now. We will then look at clusters and get a rating done of all these clusters.** When I do the clusterisation, I will work with rating agencies. By the way, we have started to show the cluster and a cluster-wise rating.

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To say India is behind in hi-tech is a fallacy. We are just trying to portray the right picture. I believe that we at Invest India are best positioned to partner with nations for sovereign money, with investors for VC/PE, for institutional investors for long-term funds. I have plagiarised my own statement that I built for Intel, for Invest India. At Intel, I would say, ‘I want to maximise Intel with maximum India,’ but I would take the second part equally that ‘I want to maximise India with maximum Intel’. Now at Invest India, I say, ‘I want to maximise India with a maximum world,’ but I also want to maximise the world with maximum India. We have the capability. We have R&D capability, we have scale, we have a national-level platform on the might of software. We have 60 million-plus MSMEs. How do we get them a global audience in a global market? My new charter is, of course, to bring investments, whether through FDI or through trade. This is Invest India. Earlier, we did not have the mandate for trade and technology, but this

is needed now. Investment, trade and technology are kind of hand in glove.

**Q: On the ground, private investments haven’t really taken off and the PLI scheme has had mixed success. What kind of measures need to be taken further?**

**A:** I have a very strong background in statistics, and I do not believe that looking at one year’s or two years’ FDI data is the story to tell. We analysed the last 21 years, and we saw that in the last seven years, the average FDI was \$71 billion. In the seven-year period before that, it was \$41 billion, and in the seven-year period prior to that, it was \$18 billion. Now we see the trend. **Our goal for the coming seven years is to get \$110 billion FDI on average every year.** I am highlighting to investors that the Indian economy has huge growth potential. I am telling companies and countries—in the terminology of young India—to partner with us or else they will have the Fear of Missing Out or FOMO.

**Q: What are the expectations from the private sector in terms of further reforms?**

**A:** We have travelled to many places, and I have asked investors why they are on the fence. The No. 1 concern was not just policy consistency, but policy transparency. They said that if we change policies, we should explain the process and keep them in the loop. The second concern was about policy consistency and not to change policies quickly based on whims and fancies. The third was in terms of ease of doing business—people want more freedom of repatriation. They also want the benefit of partnerships and free trade agreements in terms of exports and imports. Easier listing of companies is another reform they want. All of these are not very hard to change. People also want to understand [the process] a little bit better. **Our team is working with a start-up on an I-Chat tool. It is not ready to be rolled out. It will have all the policies and regulations of all the states and Union Territories with an AI solution. It will enable investors to quickly look at policies and benefits and compare them across states.** For instance, if they want to invest in car tyre manufacturing, it will provide a table of good incentives and a supplier ecosystem, as well as information on states that already have car tyre manufacturers and the state policies that can help and give benefits. We are also doing supply chain clustering with HSN code (a global method to classify goods) that can be fed into this. For now, the tool will only be for policy comparison. But my goal will be that the landing platform will have suppliers plotted across the country and then investors can see where they can go and get